

ASMIT DATTA

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First, I would like to talk about how I approach problems, how I get better at them, and how I work in a team. I accept it when I fall short of understanding something, and I give my best to understand it from people better than me. I have a lot of respect for anyone I can learn from, and I am not ashamed to ask the same question twice if that is what it takes. It works the other way too. When someone is stuck on something I have already worked out, I will sit with them rather than hand over the answer, and I come out of those understanding it better than when I went in. Knowledge seems to be one of the few things that grows when you share it. I think about problems in systems, and I approach them that way. I think that is also what makes me useful explaining something to someone else - I still remember what it is like to not understand it yet.

The work closest to what the posting describes is a summer I spent at the University of Delhi under Prof. R. P. Singh, optimizing Gaussian Process classifiers for high-dimensional data. Since then most of my data work has been in Python and SQL. Lead Engine keeps five scout agents running across Zillow, Redfin, FSBO, expired listings and the Maricopa County Assessor, deduplicates what they find by address, and scores every lead with the reasoning written out beside the score - 2,129 leads sourced. The dashboard over it is a live pipeline graph, so a failed scout shows up the moment it fails. I have not used Qualtrics. I looked it up before writing this. The workflow - write the questions and the branching, collect the responses, clean them, export them - is close to what Lead Engine does with listings, so the tool is new to me but the work is not. Pash, a side project that splits a song into its parts, is the usual pattern: I wanted it to exist, so I learned Demucs and wired S3, SQS and a remote CUDA worker together with nobody to ask. Most of what I know got learned that way.

For the writing, what I can point to is the AI Society at Arizona State, where I wrote the materials for and ran the workshops that made machine learning approachable to students with no technical background. I also mentored four freshmen through their first ML project. Your paper this year in JAMA Network Open is the same problem from the other side. Patients open their test results before a clinician has talked them through, and the ones with less digital literacy come away not understanding what they read. That is the kind of work I would like to be part of.

I can commit the ten hours a week the posting describes through the fall semester. My classes are on Tuesday and Wednesday evenings and Friday late morning, and I have none on Monday or Thursday, so I can figure out a flexible schedule around them. I am on an F-1 visa, which permits on-campus employment without further authorization. I would be glad to talk about what the project needs.